

Palo Alto Networks: data center intent at 100, but the list is mostly sellers

Account entry plan for Spencer Refer | Prepared Thursday, October 1, 2026 | Sources: HubSpot, Lemlist, ZoomInfo

100 Data Center intent (Sep 12)	98 Equinix intent (Sep 19)	30 PANW contacts in HubSpot	~10 Leaders enrollees who aren't buyers
STAGE Prospect. No deal.	RUNNING NOW CTF ENT - Leaders (13 leads incl. EA, federal sales, field CIO); INTL (Uri Eliyahu, Ahmed Fahmy)	LAST TOUCH Sep 30: enrollments	NEXT STEP Mon Oct 5: email Matt Riddle (Sr Director, IT Cloud and Infrastructure)

Bottom line

Palo Alto Networks (\$11.5B revenue; bought CyberArk in Feb 2026) showed **Data Center 100, Equinix 98, Bandwidth 91** and Networking Solutions 88 in September. That suggests real facility work, possibly tied to the CyberArk integration or its own cloud security PoPs. The Leaders list is mostly people who sell security (an executive assistant, federal sales, field CIOs). The buyers are in IT: **Matt Riddle (Sr Director, IT Cloud and Infrastructure)** and **Ahmed Fahmy (Staff IT Telecom Engineer)**, who was put in the international list.

What PANW is, in one analogy

We've been talking to the store's salespeople. The person who buys the store's own electricity is in the back office.

Signals worth citing

Signal	Source	So what for the opener
Data Center 100 (B), Bandwidth 91 (B), Colocation 70 (Sep 5-12)	ZoomInfo intent	Facility research.
Equinix 98, Networking Solutions 88 (Sep 19)	ZoomInfo intent	Evaluating Equinix.
Acquired CyberArk (Feb 2026)	Lemlist note	Integration of networks and sites.

Work already in motion

Lots of enrollments, mostly with the wrong roles.

When	Channel / campaign	What happened	Read
Sep 30	CTF ENT - Leaders	Tejveer Yadav, Celia Z, Claire Liu (CISO), Kane C, Michael Gregg, Shay Nahari, Paul Aubin (Fed Sales), Fiona Green (EA), Fadi Fadhil, Ajit Sane	Mostly wrong audience
Sep 30	CTF INTL	Uri Eliyahu (Dir IT Cloud Ops), Ahmed Fahmy (Staff IT Telecom Eng)	Buyers in the wrong list

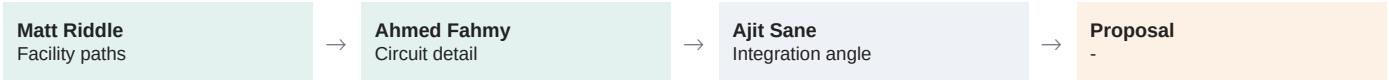
Who to reach, in order

Contact	Title (source)	Where	Why they matter	Status / email
Matt Riddle	Sr Director, IT Cloud and Infrastructure (HubSpot)	n/a	Owner.	Not contacted
Ahmed Fahmy	Staff IT Telecom Engineer (HubSpot)	n/a	Orders circuits.	INTL; move
Uri Eliyahu	Director, IT Cloud Ops (Lemlist)	n/a	Cloud ops.	INTL
Ajit Sane	Director, M&A and IT PMO (Lemlist)	n/a	CyberArk integration.	Leaders

Not worth chasing for this goal

Sales, field CIOs, SASE architects (they design customers' networks), EA, CISO.

How the access path should run



Messages, by contact

1. Matt Riddle Sr Director, IT Cloud and Infrastructure
Why them: Owner.

Channel: Email Mon Oct 5 | Subject: PANW's Chicago Equinix paths
Matt, if Palo Alto Networks is evaluating Equinix space in Chicago, Crosstown is on-net at CH1/CH2/CH4 at 350 E Cermak and CH3 in Elk Grove, with underground fiber mapped to the conduit. That makes diverse paths simple to prove. Worth 20 minutes?

2. Ahmed Fahmy Staff IT Telecom Engineer
Why them: Circuit owner.

Channel: Email Wed Oct 7 | Subject: Chicago conduit map (KMZ)
Ahmed, I can send our Chicago KMZ so you can check where PANW's circuits share paths today. Want it?

The plan

When	Move	Notes
Fri Oct 2	Pause sales, EA and CISO leads in Leaders; move Fahmy and Eliyahu to direct email.	-
Mon Oct 5	Email Matt Riddle.	-
Wed Oct 7	Email Ahmed Fahmy.	-
Mon Oct 12	Email Ajit Sane on the integration angle.	-
Week of Oct 26	Goal: path review.	-

What progress looks like (for management)

By	Milestone	How we will know
Oct 16	Reply from Riddle or Fahmy	Logged
Nov 6	Path review held	Meeting logged

Guardrails

- Credits used: ZoomInfo company and signals for 1 company.

Sources

HubSpot contacts; Lemlist CTF ENT Leaders and INTL; ZoomInfo intent.